Share Our Wealth

Senator Huey P. Long · February 5, 1934

Source: Huey P. Long, "Share Our Wealth" (1934). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Louisiana's Senator Long proposed capping great fortunes and guaranteeing every family a basic share of the nation's wealth — a populist challenge from the left that pressured FDR to expand the New Deal.

To limit poverty by providing that every deserving family shall share in the wealth of America for not less than one third of the average wealth, thereby to possess not less than $5,000 free of debt. To limit fortunes to such a few million dollars as will allow the balance of the American people to share in the wealth and profits of the land. Old-age pensions of $30 per month to persons over 60 years of age who do not earn as much as $1,000 per year or who possess less than $10,000 in cash or property. To limit the hours of work to such an extent as to prevent overproduction and to give the workers of America some share in the recreations, conveniences, and luxuries of life. To balance agricultural production with what can be sold and consumed according to the laws of God, which have never failed. To care for the veterans of our wars. Taxation to run the Government to be supported, first, by reducing big fortunes from the top.

[. . .]

There is nothing wrong with the United States. We have more food than we can eat. We have more clothes and things out of which to make clothes than we can wear. So what is the trouble? Nothing except that a handful of men have everything and the balance of the people have nothing if their debts were paid. There should be every man a king in this land flowing with milk and honey instead of the lords of finance at the top and slaves and peasants at the bottom.